painless and seamless as possible. I personally like Groovy because it's a popular language, easy to use, highly supported, gets better with every release, does a lot of the programming tedium for you, and can run on the Java VM (JVM), which makes it highly portable and scalable. In short, it's a Swiss army knife that lets you build stuff fast. If there are examples in certain languages you really want to see, feel free to request help on the Author Online forum,[1] and I can help post examples in whatever language you'd like to use.

[1] www.manning-sandbox.com/forum.jspa?forumID=924&start=0

In appendix B I'll give more information about the details of the Grails app if you want to tweak it. But it should work out of the box with a few configuration tweaks if you don't want to get under the hood.

I've included a shell script with the code that will walk you through the configuration of the system. It will ask you for the URLs and credentials for all the supported systems you want to connect to, so you should have those ready. You have to enter credentials as base64-encoded strings that can be used for HTTP basic auth. For example, if your username is UserOne and your password is h0lm3s, then your basic auth string would be UserOne:h0lm3s. You can use a local utility to base64 encode your strings, or you can go to a site like www.base64encode.org/.

The shell script will copy the file measurementor.properties to a new file called application.properties. Then it will take the parameters you pass into the shell script and update the settings for the application. If you don't run the shell script or want to change anything, you can do the steps manually by copying measurementor.properties to a new file called application.properties and adding the URLs to the systems you want to connect to. An example for JIRA connectivity should look like the following listing.

Listing A.3. Setting up your config file